

pink power.



S A B R I N A
O R T I Z

A glimpse into High
School writing and how
I've grown since

EXCERPTS FROM THEN AND NOW

the “r” word.

I hate the world resilience

the assumption of repeat
they can do it again, they can handle it
what’s loss to a people who had nothing?
glass tower, watching from their curtains

I hate the word resilience

the way it makes me curl my toes,
shrink my height to half my soul
forced to bend down on my knees
thank the government for release

I hate the word resilience

when all is silent, world is still
biggest typhoon in Asia, 6000 killed
“I saw hope in their eyes,” they said
“here, have some relief packages instead”

I hate the world resilience

not when the Filipino people deserve more
stray dog, completing every chore
act like a sinner, go to confession
priest is corrupt, he handles the system

I hate the world resilience

but most of all how they keep using
a word so small to capture this feeling
of generations lost, of people grieving
bullet-proof shields, who are they protecting?

for it’s not my people that get a chance
not a survival, an instinct, or a life to have
because what they don’t put in the fine description
is that it’s already decided who gets to have vision

so we keep living and charging forward
pushing past waves that rock
big boat toward us, ripples chase
we didn’t ask for this

I hate the world resilience

like a rubber band that springs back to place
our boat is sinking, they stop the race
“what happened to being so resilient?”
look around, what do you think was missing?

I hate the world resilience

pink power.

When the power of the people
Come together as one
It all becomes equal,
For a leader has won
Maybe not by votes, but by heart
And the count of those who came
You can see those who took part
And their burning spark and flame

For on the 20th of March
People stood and people marched
To Pasig City, Emerald Avenue,
The streets filled with a pink and green hue

Waves of people flood in
Ripples of change in the current
Over 130,000 of us
Footsteps pounding against the road,
Hearing hearts beat louder as we strode
Towards a brighter tomorrow, a bigger change
Towards a future we could rearrange

A future colored pink
With a nation that starts to think
With people as roses in bloom

I stand before you now,
A shadow of who I once was
For the collective way of the world
I now stand for a cause

So stand, and fight with might
For if you believe, and do things right
Then no matter what it is — despite
I promise you: the future we have is bright.

References

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HIGH SCHOOL

CREATIVE WRITING 12